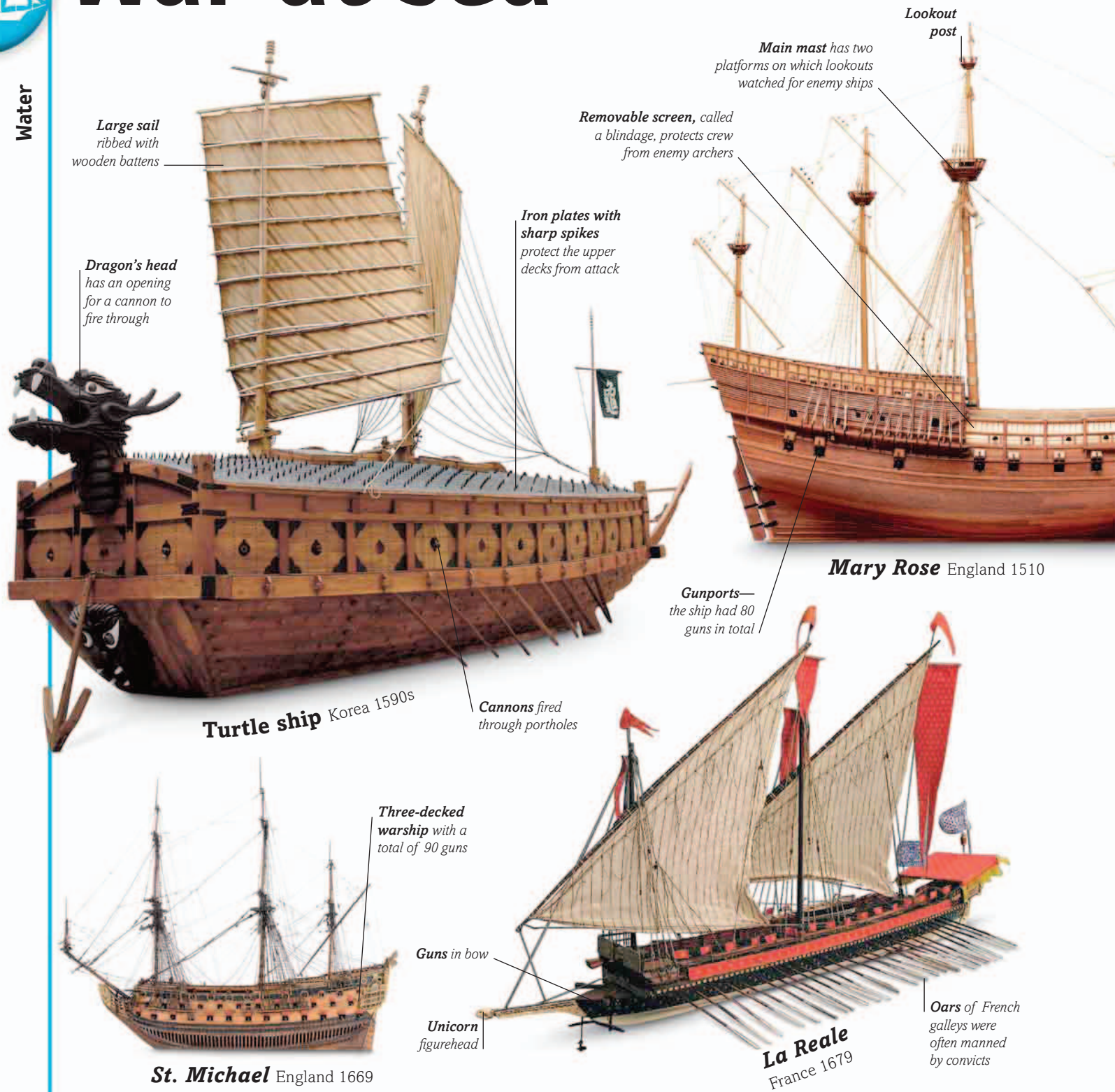




War at sea



Large sail
ribbed with
wooden battens

Dragon's head
has an opening
for a cannon to
fire through

*Iron plates with
sharp spikes*
protect the upper
decks from attack

*Lookout
post*
*Main mast has two
platforms on which lookouts
watched for enemy ships*

*Removable screen, called
a blindage, protects crew
from enemy archers*

Mary Rose England 1510

*Gunports—
the ship had 80
guns in total*

Turtle ship Korea 1590s

*Cannons fired
through portholes*

*Three-decked
warship with a
total of 90 guns*

St. Michael England 1669

Guns in bow

*Unicorn
figurehead*

La Reale
France 1679

*Oars of French
galleys were
often manned
by convicts*

For almost as long as there have been ships, the sea has been a battlefield for rival nations planning invasion, or for control of shipping routes and trade. From the 16th century, warships bristled with guns and battles at sea became even more deadly.

Before naval artillery, battles at sea were mostly close combat, with fire, rams, or arrows used in attack. The Korean **turtle ship** protected itself against archers, and from being boarded, with its hefty, spiked deck armor. Big guns allowed ships to fight more at a distance. The **Mary Rose's** iron